Vendor Due-Diligence *Agent*

PRE-SCREENED

SUBJECT

Any company, before it becomes a vendor

CHECKS

Identity, sanctions, adverse media

TIME

About a minute per report

PREPARED BY

Pieter Albrecht, November 2026

Three questions before a company becomes a *vendor*

Q1

Who is it really?

Legal entity, LEI, address and parent companies from GLEIF and the KvK

Q2

Is it sanctioned?

Every name screened against EU, UK, US and other lists from OpenSanctions

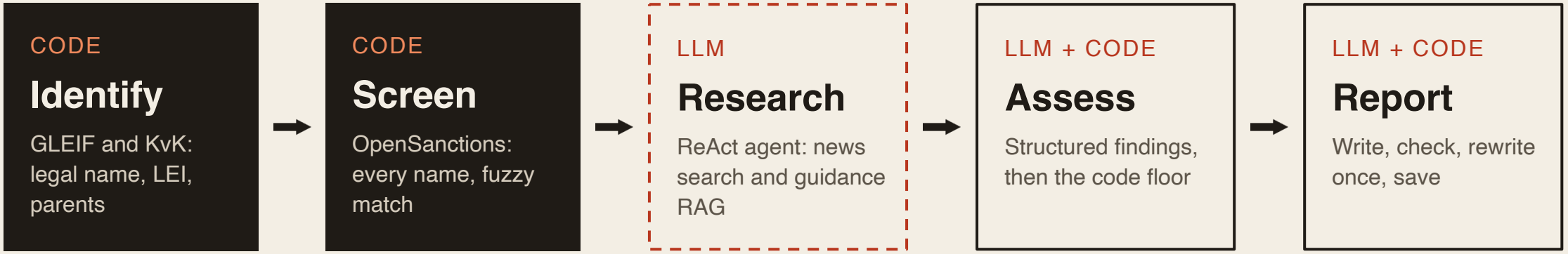
Q3

What does the news say?

Fines, investigations and settlements, weighed against AML guidance

BY HAND hours per vendor → THE AGENT a sourced report in about a minute

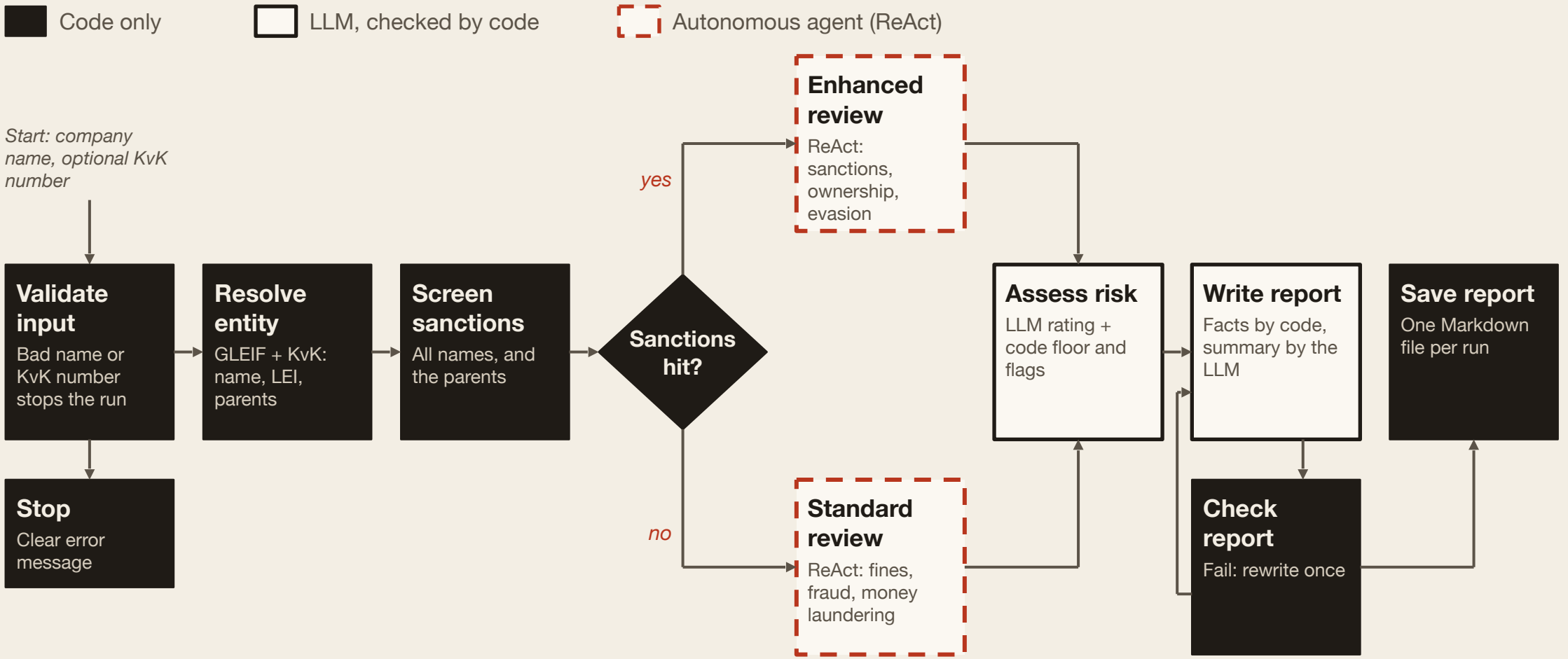
One LangGraph run, from a *name* to a report



Routers: a real sanctions hit sends the run to the enhanced review; a failed report check sends it back for one rewrite.

RAG: 805 chunks of DNB, EU and FATF guidance in Pinecone; every red flag cites its page.

The agent decides, *code sets the limits*



Every box is a LangGraph node. Two routers: the sanctions check picks the review route, the report check sends a failed draft back once.

Code decides, the LLM *explains*

Code: what must be right

- Entity resolution and match scores
- Sanctions matching on every name
- The minimum rating: strictest rule wins

LLM: what needs judgement

- Research agent: 6 searches, 20 steps
- Synthesis without tools, structured output
- The report text

Checks on the LLM

- Every amount must be in the articles
- Every finding must name the company
- Every source must have been retrieved
- One event, one red flag

The LLM can make a rating stricter, never milder.

SUBJECT

Sberbank

EXPECTED: HIGH
DO NOT ONBOARD

The verdict comes from a code rule, not from the LLM.

1 · IDENTITY

The Russian legal name, in Cyrillic, from GLEIF

2 · SCREENING

Company, name as given and former names

3 · ROUTE

A real hit sends it to the enhanced review

4 · AUDIT TRAIL

Evidence, source and guidance page per red flag

Three things that taught me *the most*

INCIDENT 01

A company that does not exist

Rated “strong compliance status, high confidence, Onboard”.

Fix: identity not verified means at least Medium, Escalate.

No data is not no risk

INCIDENT 02

€1.45 billion that never existed

The model added up fines; the real ING settlement was €775M.

Fix: every amount checked against the article text; rewrite on failure.

The prompt asks, the code checks

INCIDENT 03

A fix that broke two companies

The Heineken fix sent Philips to Philips GmbH and Shell to a UK holding.

Fix: exact-name searches always run; a 7-company regression test.

Re-test after every change

Four ways to run the *same* agent

Terminal

main.py, with a label for each run in LangSmith

Streamlit

Live steps, rating banner, report download

FastAPI

/check and /jobs, protected with an API key

n8n form

Anyone can check a vendor, no Python needed



The API key is an encrypted n8n credential, never in the exported workflow.

It can’t yet tell a perpetrator from a *victim*

Company	Red flag in the report	What actually happened
ASML	Medium: former employee jailed for sharing trade secrets with Russia	ASML was the victim: the employee stole its secrets
Heineken	Medium: corruption charges against an Asia Pacific manager	Heineken was the victim: he was charged with cheating the company

Why it isn’t dangerous

The error is too strict, never a false all-clear, and the evidence is in the report.

Next-sprint fix

A company_role field (perpetrator, victim, mentioned); the code caps victim findings at Low.

Next *sprints*

01

Company role

Perpetrator, victim or mentioned, so victims are no longer flagged

02

Live KvK register

A production key instead of the test environment

03

Ownership checks

UBOs and the EU 50% rule for owners who are sanctioned

Full plan: gtm_future_sprints.md in the repo

Thank you.
Questions?

CASE CLOSED

github.com/PietFALB/vendor-dd-agent

Pieter Albrecht

No data is *not* no risk

Situation	Minimum rating	Recommendation
Strong match on an EU or UK-listed entity	High	Do not onboard
Other strong sanctions match	High	Escalate
Possible real hit, screening incomplete, or identity not verified	Medium	Escalate
News search failed	Medium	Onboard with conditions

All rules are checked and the **strictest wins**. Before this, a wrong news API key produced “no adverse media, Low, Onboard” for a bank with a €775M AML settlement.